LAB 08

2. Phase 1: REVIEW

Retrieve your Lab 07 checkpoint. Keep the SAME primary riskiest assumption unless you can justify a change. Verify that your hypothesis, measured behavior, protocol and decision criteria are aligned.

Review question	Team response
What is your selected riskiest assumption?	A1: UDST students and faculty will go back to the event platform on their own, without reminders, to check upcoming events. Kept from Lab 07: still high importance with weak evidence, and A3 and A4 depend on it.
What behavior or outcome will you observe?	Return visits without reminders: a participant opens the platform on 2 or more separate days between day 3 and day 10. Days 1–2 don't count, so first-time curiosity isn't counted (from the Lab 07 peer review).
What would contradict your hypothesis?	Most participants open it on day 1 and don't come back, like with Navigate360. Or, at the end, most say they still heard about their last event from Outlook, Instagram or friends.
What are the original success, failure and inconclusive criteria?	**SUCCESS:** 6+ of 10 (≥60%) return on 2+ separate days. **FAILURE:** 3 or fewer of 10 (≤30%). **INCONCLUSIVE:** 4–5 of 10, OR fewer than 8 finish, OR tracking fails. Thresholds unchanged from Lab 07. Only the time window changes from 14 to 10 days (see Phase 4), decided before any data.
Which two weaknesses could compromise the experiment?	**1) "Visit" is not defined** (raised in the Lab 07 peer review). Reloads, two devices or opening without the code could make us count too many or too few returns. **2) Biased sample and briefing.** Friends from our classes, or an intro like "check it often", could make people visit to help us, not because they need it.

Explain two changes that would improve the experiment and why each change matters. Do not silently rewrite thresholds after observing results.

Change 1 – Clear visit definition. A visit = one day per participant code (Qatar time); reloads or two devices on the same day count once, and visits without a code are counted separately. This matters because our result depends on counting return days per person the same way for everyone.

Change 2 – Less biased recruitment and a fixed script. At least 5 of 10 participants come from outside our classes and friends, and everyone hears the same short script that doesn't mention coming back. This matters because people are less likely to visit just to help us.

Thresholds stay as in Lab 07; both changes come from the Lab 07 peer review and were made before any data.

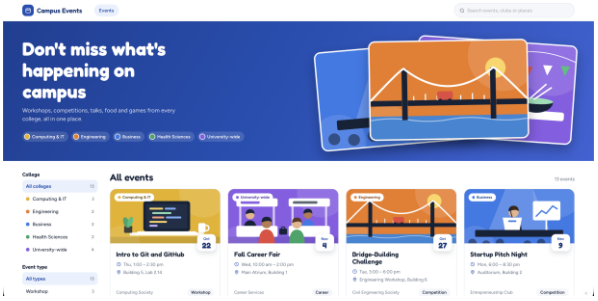
OUTPUT 1 | Reviewed experiment protocol and two justified improvements.

3. Phase 2: PREPARE

Create the materials needed to execute your chosen experiment. Select the appropriate type; a landing page is not mandatory.

Learning objective / experiment	Examples of required materials
Past behavior / interviews	Neutral interview guide, recruitment criteria, response log
Initial commitment / fake door	Landing page or signup flow, clear call to action, event log
Value in use / prototype test	Clickable prototype, participant tasks, observation sheet
Concierge pilot	Service workflow, task instructions, outcome log
Technical feasibility / spike	Test environment, repeatable test cases, measurement log

Experiment component	Your preparation
Participant action or test procedure	**Main: concierge pilot (10 days).** Before day 1: screening + consent. Day 1: personal link (e.g. .../?p=S07) + 1-minute script. Days 2–10: no contact; we add real UDST events every Sun/Tue/Thu. After day 10: one exit question: "Think of the last university event you went to or seriously considered. Where did you first hear about it?" **Extra for LM2: past-behavior interviews** (8–10 people, 10 min each): when did they last check Navigate360 or any events list on their own, and how did they hear about the last event they went to?
Artifact or setup (include link/file)	• Site: our Lab 06 prototype, still being refined based on feedback, then published on GitHub Pages with real UDST events and tested before Day 1 (not live yet) • Visit log: Google Sheet that saves code + date each time the site opens (not set up yet; set up and tested with the site before Day 1)

	• Interview guide, Day-1 script, consent text and tally sheet (drafted, in GitHub docs/lab08/) •  Note: Still refining this but it will be done before day 1
Metric and how it will be recorded	**Main metric:** % of participants with 2+ return days (days 3–10). A visit = one day per code (Qatar time). Duplicates and test codes (T01–T04) are removed. Someone who never returns is "did not return", not a drop-out. **Secondary:** exit question answers; interview answers logged per person (what they actually did, not opinions).
Consent, privacy or safety precautions	• Consent at recruitment; anyone can leave at any time. • Only codes in the log, no names or emails. • Site says it is a student project, not an official UDST service; every event links to its original announcement. • No reminders during the pilot; we don't recruit our own instructors.

BE SPECIFIC A polished interface alone is not evidence. Explain how the artifact makes the predicted behavior observable and measurable.

OUTPUT 2 | At least one usable experiment artifact and an evidence collection instrument.

4. Phase 3: PILOT

Conduct a small pilot with a suitable participant if feasible. Otherwise, exchange materials with another team for a structured walkthrough. Check the procedure and measurement process, not whether the business hypothesis is true.

Pilot / walkthrough question	Observation
Who tried the procedure and in what role?	Two other teams tried our Lab 06 prototype during the Week 6 lab, acting as participants. For Lab 08 we walked through the experiment procedure ourselves (script, consent and a sample log table on paper), one member acting as a participant and one as the team member. The site is not live yet.

Were the instructions understandable?	Mostly. Screening and consent were clear, but our intro said "check it during the week", which sounded like they had to visit often.
Could the intended behavior be observed?	Yes, if every visit is saved with the participant's code and date. We checked this by filling a sample log table by hand for a few made-up visits.
Could the metric be collected reliably?	Not yet. Questions came up: what if someone opens it from a bookmark without the code, uses two devices, or reloads many times? And which time zone counts as "one day"? A late-night visit could fall on the wrong day.
What broke, confused or delayed the process?	The intro wording, and the exit question was unclear (an event they "attended" or just "looked at"?). This was only a procedure check, not evidence for our hypothesis.

INTERPRETATION Peer feedback or a classroom walkthrough is a procedural check, NOT validation of the venture hypothesis. Distinguish pilot findings from later experimental evidence.

OUTPUT 3 | Brief pilot/walkthrough record with concrete findings.

5. Phase 4: REFINE

Fix problems found during the pilot. Keep a trace of the original protocol and predefined criteria. If a metric, threshold or hypothesis must change, explain why and record the revised version BEFORE collecting validation evidence.

Problem found	Revision made	Why it improves evidence quality
"Visit" unclear (no code, two devices, reloads, time zone); intro hinted people should visit often.	Visit = one day per code, Qatar time; no-code visits counted separately. Fixed 1-minute script that doesn't mention coming back.	Everyone is counted the same way, and people visit because it's useful, not to please us.
Exit question unclear; site not live yet.	One fixed exit question, asked after the last day. Site published and tested with test codes before Day 1.	Answers mean the same thing, and we don't start until tracking works.
A 14-day run would end around 3 weeks after LM2 (3 Nov).	Window shortened from 14 to 10 days (returns counted on days 3–10), decided now, before any data. Thresholds unchanged. Past-behavior interviews added for LM2.	Final result comes about 2 weeks after LM2 and well before finals. 10 days still covers two teaching weeks. It is a slightly stricter test, so a success would still be meaningful.

Final readiness check: Are materials functional? Are target participants reachable? Can you record the metric? Are the success, failure and inconclusive criteria still explicit?

Team readiness answer: Script, consent text, interview guide and tally sheet are drafted. The Lab 06 prototype is still being refined based on feedback; it will be published, with the Google Sheet visit log, and tested with test codes before Day 1. 3 students contacted so far. The counting rule is written down, and the criteria are explicit (unchanged thresholds, 10-day window).

OUTPUT 4 | Revised, executable experiment package with documented changes.

6. Phase 5: COMMIT & SUBMIT

Plan the real experiment for the period before LM2. Choose a feasible scope for your venture; do not invent observations or claim validation without relevant evidence.

Execution element	Team plan
Target participants / technical environment	10 UDST participants (7 students from different majors, 3 faculty) who answer YES to: "Have you ever missed a university event because you found out too late?" Site on GitHub Pages + Google Sheet log.
Recruitment / setup and planned sample or test runs	Recruit on campus, in group chats outside our sections, and by emailing faculty in 2+ departments. At least 5 of 10 from outside our classes and friends. One 10-day run; everyone starts the same day.
Execution date and responsible team member(s)	**Interviews:** 30 Oct – 2 Nov **LM2:** Tue 3 Nov **Site live + recruitment:** by Thu 5 Nov **Day 1:** Sun 8 Nov **Day 10:** Tue 17 Nov **Exit question:** 18 Nov **Founder Decision:** by 20 Nov **Roles:** everyone – recruitment + interviews; Salma & Dania – site, event updates + visit log; Aly & Mawada – daily log check + analysis.
Evidence capture and storage location	GitHub docs/lab08/: protocol, script, interview notes, visit log export (codes only), tally sheet, exit answers. The code-to-contact list stays with one member and is deleted after the pilot.
Risks, constraints and fallback plan	• **At LM2** we report the interview findings and the ready experiment, clearly marked as not yet run. We won't claim validation. • **Site not ready by 5 Nov:** we move the whole schedule, we don't shorten it further. • **Fewer than 8 finish or data is lost:** INCONCLUSIVE (Lab 07 criteria). • **Tracking stops:** one member checks the log daily.